



Budget Truly Wireless Earphones

(under ₹5K)

Small price to pay for excellent performance

The world of TWS earphones has seen an exponential growth in the last couple of years. Audio brands are making earbuds that are packed with features and offer great performance. Special attention has been paid to the budget segment, which generally caps off at the ₹5,000 mark. You no longer need to break the bank to get features like ANC, great mics, water resistance, and long lasting batteries that also charge quickly. While these earbuds might not appeal to the purists and audiophiles, in day to day use, they work just fine. So, we went ahead and found out which TWS earbuds you should go for if you are looking for great performance under ₹5,000. Let's find out the 2022 winner of the Digit Zero1 Award in this category.

Winner: Realme Buds Air 3

The Realme Buds Air 3 are the best performing earbuds under ₹5,000. They bring a great sound signature to the table, the kind that will get you through a whole day of pleasant music listening, video watching, and calling. Realme Buds Air 3 sport 10mm LCP dynamic drivers and have a V shaped sound signature. This means that they sound great when you are listening to

most popular genres of music. The bass response is pretty refined and punchy, straying away from the muddy and bloated sound signature that the buds in this price range tend to have. The Active Noise Cancellation was also a place where we were pleasantly surprised. Realme's R3 chip did a great job of handling ambient noise and sounds like the humming of the AC. All of it is powered by the battery that lasted for a total of 21 hours during our testing. All in all, a deserving winner!

Runner-up and Best Buy: Oppo Enco Air 2 Pro

In our testing, the Oppo Enco Air 2 Pro came pretty close to claiming the top spot. If you look at the numbers, the price difference between these two buds is just ₹500, which might not seem like as big a difference otherwise. However, in this price range, it could be a deal breaker for many. So, considering that, it made sense for the Oppo Enco Air 2 Pro to be crowned the Runner-up in



Realme Buds Air 3

Price: Starting at ₹3,999

its category and the winner of the Best Buy Award. The places where the Oppo Enco Air 2 Pro lagged, were the bass and mids. In our time of testing the earphones, we found the bass response to be reasonable for the price, but a bit too overwhelming for anything other than pop music, hip-hop, and rap. The mids were also subdued, which made the sound feel slightly veiled and lacking clarity. Where these earphones made up for all the lost ground was the highs. They fared much better in reproduction of those frequencies. The ANC on these earphones was also something that is great for the price but not as great as the Buds Air 3. The battery on the earbuds and the case lasted for 25 hours in total. It was a close race to the top step. The Oppo Enco Air 2 Pro missed out on the top spot, but the lower cost of the buds made them the best contender for our Best Buy award.

2nd Runner-up: Blaupunkt BTW-09 Moksha

Blaupunkt's BTW-09 MOKSHA earphones put up a great fight. However, some of their shortcomings prevented them from overtaking our winner and Best Buy. In terms of their sound signature, the place where they struggled the most was the bass response. The sound coming out of the buds due to the over-emphasised bass meant that the mids and the high, which were arguably better than the other two earphones in this list, were pulled down.

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DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2022



Oppo Enco Air 2 Pro
Price: ₹3,499



Blaupunkt
BTW-09
Moksha
Price: ₹3,999